Yihong Liu

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Research Interests

Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference

Education

University of California, Santa Barbara — Expected June 2027
Ph.D. in Economics — *Santa Barbara, CA*

Duke University — June 2021
M.A. in Economics — *Durham, NC*

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics — June 2019
B.A. in Economics — *Shanghai, China*

Research

Job Market Paper

"Matched Triple-Differences: A Framework for Covariate Adjustment". October 2026.

Abstract: A common empirical strategy in triple-differences (DDD) is to include either covariate trends or covariate levels in a three-way fixed effects (3WFE) regression. We formally study both 3WFE specifications and show that, in general, neither consistently estimates the average treatment effect on the treated (ATT). Our diagnosis has two parts. First, we show that the OLS estimands of both specifications use incorrect weighting schemes and thus fail to satisfy the covariate balancing condition. Second, we characterize the additional assumptions under which each OLS estimand equals the ATT. To address these limitations, we propose a matched triple-differences framework that accommodates a general class of matching procedures, including nearest-neighbor matching and kernel matching. Within this framework, we construct a class of consistent matching estimators, establish their asymptotic normality, and provide a consistent variance estimator that accounts for the variability introduced by the matching step. Our empirical application shows that the proposed matched triple-differences estimator can yield estimates and qualitative conclusions that differ from those obtained using the 3WFE regression.

Working Papers

"Post-Matching Two-Way Fixed Effects Estimation" (with Gonzalo Vazquez-Bare). October 2026.

"Estimating Resource Games with Nonlinear Dynamics" (with Shuchen Tsao, submitted). October 2026.

Work in Progress

"Triple-Differences with a Continuous Treatment"

"Identification and Inference on Treatment Effects under Covariate-Adaptive Randomization and Sample Selection"

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026: Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics (SOCAE), University of California, Santa Barbara (CARE, AMEL), AERE session at the Western Economic Association International (WEAI)

2025: University of California, Santa Barbara (AMEL)

2024: CES North America Conference

Teaching Experience

University of California, Santa Barbara

Econ 241A	Econometrics I (Ph.D. Level)	Fall 2024, 2025
Econ 241B	Econometrics II (Ph.D. Level)	Winter 2023, 2024, 2026
Econ 210A	Microeconomic Theory I (Ph.D. Level)	Fall 2022, 2023
Econ 140C	Machine Learning and AI	Fall 2026
Econ 140A	Introduction to Econometrics I	Spring 2023, 2025
Econ 2	Introductory Macroeconomics	Spring 2022
Econ 1	Introductory Microeconomics	Fall 2021, Winter 2022

Awards & Honors

Job Market Fellowship 2026
University of California, Santa Barbara

Research Quarter Fellowship 2025, 2026
University of California, Santa Barbara

Outstanding Graduate Course Teaching Assistant of the Year 2024
University of California, Santa Barbara

Gretler Fellowship 2024
University of California, Santa Barbara

M.A. Merit Scholar Award 2019, 2020
Duke University

Renmin Scholarship of the Graduating Class: Third Prize 2019
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics

Outstanding Exchange Student of SUFE: Second Prize 2018
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics

Skills

Programming Languages: Stata, R, MATLAB

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

References

Douglas Steigerwald
Professor
University of California, Santa Barbara
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Max Farrell
Associate Professor
University of California, Santa Barbara
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Gonzalo Vazquez-Bare
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Andrew Plantinga
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